

VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Shields and Bucklers

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1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

2. Definition

"**Shields and Bucklers**" are the terms used to describe every protection made of wood or steel and designed to protect yourself.

Shields and Bucklers can be:

- **Heater Shields**

Shields made of triangular shape, the most common shape of Shields from the XIIIth century and beyond. They must be made of wood.

- **Punch Shields**

Punch Shields are primarily designed to hit the opponent. It includes a wide variety of shapes. They must be made of wood.

- **Round Shields**

Shields made of a round shape, very common throughout the middle ages. They can be made of wood or metal.

- **Bucklers**

Small round shape Shields with central handle, mainly used in duels and as a secondary equipment for close defense. They can be made of wood or metal.

3. General Requirements

All types of Shields and Bucklers must respect the following requirements:

- be based on historical sources,
- must reproduce the proportions and curves based on historical sources,
- must be made of wood or metal. Any other material must be approved by the Authenticity Committee to be allowed in Buhurt International events,
- must match the style of the armor kit of the competitor.

All images, drawings, and paintings on Shields must be stylized in accordance with the style of the armor kit of the competitor.

It is prohibited to decorate Shields and Bucklers with images that are clearly modern and/or offensive.

The weight of all Shields and Bucklers must not exceed 5 kg.

It is allowed to use bolts and nuts to fasten straps:

- nuts must not protrude the screw,
- bolts and nuts must be painted in black or concealed with leather or fabric.

All straps must be made of leather.

Any metal part of the Shield or Buckler must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations*" document.

Any textile or leather part of the Shield or Buckler must conform to the "*Textiles and Leather*" document.

4. Wooden Shields Requirements

The entire edge must be covered with either a band of strong leather, or with at least three or more layers of fabric.

A leather band must be glued, sewn or riveted, to the Shield. Any rivets must be neatly finished, the edge of the rivet should not stick out.

The flat outside a wooden Shield must be covered with leather or fabric.

The handles must be made of leather.

Wooden Buckler and Heater Shield with a central handle must have a handle made of wood.

Shield boss (umbo) made of metal must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"* document.

5. Metal Shields Requirements

Must be of round shapes, based on historical sources, and repeat the form of the original in all three dimensions.

The entire edge of metal Shields must be rolled to the thickness of a minimum of 4 mm or more.

The handles must be made of metal and or wood

Metal Shield and Shield boss (umbo) must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"* document.

It is allowed to blacken the back part of a metal Shield or metal Buckler.

Example:



Picture from O. Haguenstein ©

6. Heater Shields

6.1. Historical Sources and Datation

The Heater Shield the main Shield shape for knights of the Middle Ages. Its triangular shape is typical of the 14th century. The shape goes thinner as the armors become more effective.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.



Shield of Loew von Steinfurth - 1380 - Germany



Grande Chroniques de France - 1400 - France



Politica & Economica - 1376 - France

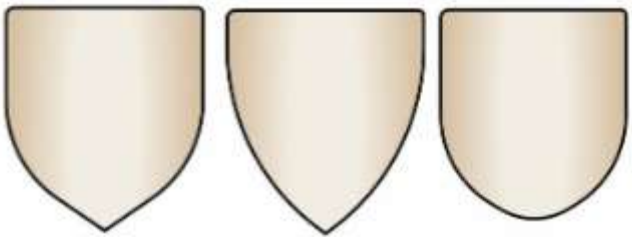


Ab Urbe Condita - 1390/1400 - France

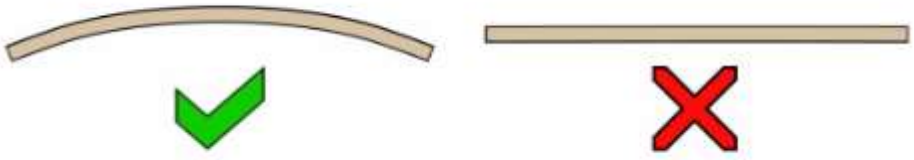
6.2. Specific Requirements

Heater Shields must:

- conform to the General Requirements and Wooden Shield requirements (*see Sections 3 and 4 above*),
- be made of wood,
- have a rectangular shape with a pointy shape at the bottom:



- be curved, not flat:



- have a length of **55 cm to 75 cm**,
- have a width of **30 cm to 65 cm**,
- have handles made of leather:

Example:



Picture from O. Haguenstein ©

It is allowed to add a Shield boss (umbo) on a Heater Shield with a central handle, as documented by historical sources.

Central handles must be made of wood.

6.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions





Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

6.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

This shape (oval) is not based on historical sources for Shield with a central handle.



Picture from The Medieval Things ©

7. Punch Shields

7.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Punch Shields are designed to strike with the edge. The handles and straps allow you to wear them in a striking position. Their shape may vary depending on the time and place. Most common shapes are rectangular, trapezoid and oval.

Their ultimate evolution is the Pavese of the 15th century. This type of Shield has a rectangular shape and a gutter in the middle.

All shapes except the Pavese are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

Pavese shape is **Approved** for **15th century armors**.

Pavese shape is **Denied** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors**.



Shield of Order Teutonicus Great Master - 1320 - Germany



Castello di Avio - 1350 - Italy



Deutsches Historisches Museum (Berlin) - 1480 - Germany



Pavese shape
with gutter in the middle



Wien Museum - 1480 - Austria



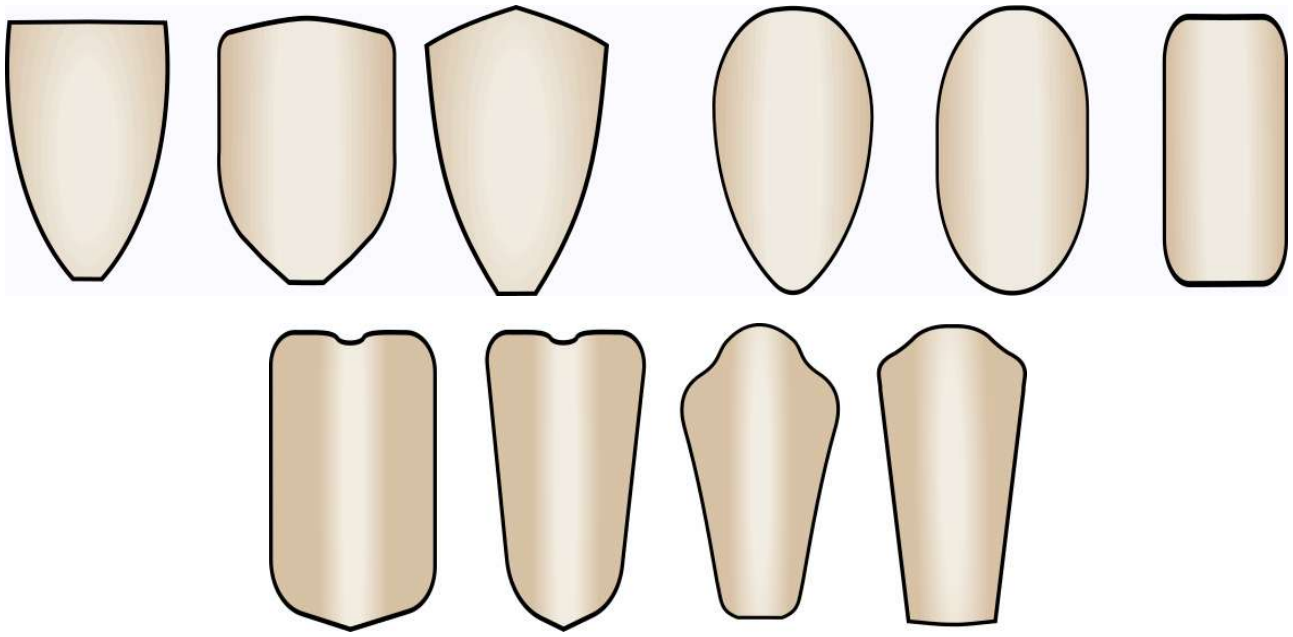


Paduan Bible - 1400 - Italy

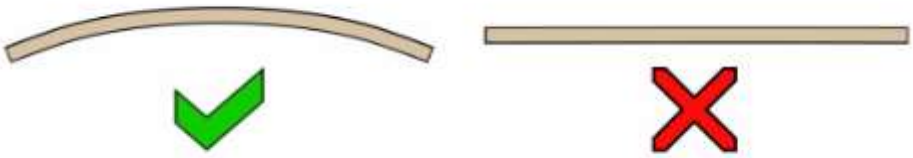
7.2. Specific Requirements

Punch Shield must:

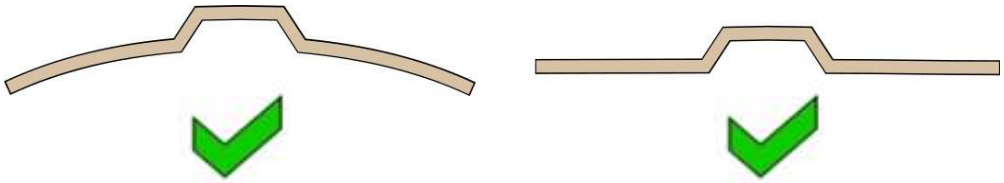
- conform to the General Requirements and Wooden Shield requirements (see Sections 3 and 4 above),
- be made of wood,
- have a shape rectangular, oval or pointed:



- be curved, not flat:



  - **Except for Pavese shape**, that can be flat if they conform to historical designs:

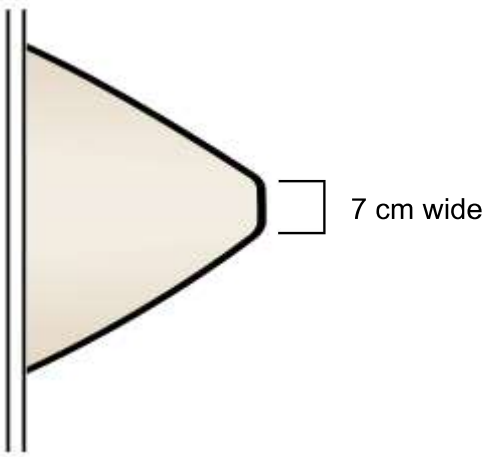


- have a length of **55 cm to 75 cm**,
- have a width of **30 cm to 50 cm**,
- have handles made of leather *(see example in 6.2. Punch Shield)*.

The striking area can be rounded or flat.

The rounded striking area must conform to a curve of **7 cm** diameter.

Flat striking area must be **7 cm** wide as a minimum.



It is not allowed to add a Shield boss (umbo) on a Punch Shield.

It is allowed to add a metal sheet on the Shield to increase its resilience. In this case:

- Additional metal sheets must be covered by leather or fabric as another part of the outside of the Shield.
- Additional metal sheets must have no sharp edges nor pointy parts.
- Additional metal sheets must be properly attached to the wooden core of the Shield, by rivets, nails or strong glue.

7.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions













Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

7.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Flat Shield



Absence of leather or 3 layers of fabric on the edge



Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

8. Round Shields

8.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Round Shields were very common in the early 14th century, and became rare while other designs spread. They are mainly made of wood. Some examples of metal round Shields exist but they are parade Shields and should be worn only with the proper set of armor of the late 15th century.

Round Shields are worn with straps made of leather.

They are **Approved** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors**.

They are **Denied** for **15th century armors** unless historical sources are provided.



Cathedral of Strasbourg - 1340 - France



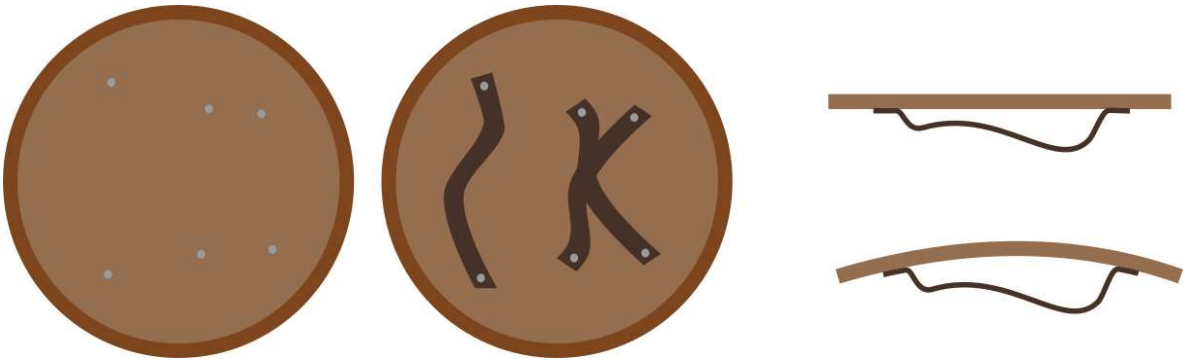
Roman de la Rose - 1350 - France

8.2. Specific Requirements

Round Shield must:

- conform to the General Requirements and either the Wooden Shield Requirements or the Metal Shield Requirements (*see Sections 3, 4 and 5 above*),
- be made of wood or metal,
    - Any metal Round Shields must be approved by the Authenticity Committee to be allowed in Buhurt International events.
- have a diameter:
    - **for Buhurt: from 25 cm to 70 cm**,
    - **for Duels: from 25 cm to 35 cm**,
- be flat or have a concave curve,
- have handles made of leather *(see example in 6.2. Punch Shield)*.

It is not allowed to add a Shield boss (umbo) on a Round Shield unless documented by historical sources.



8.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

8.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Round Shield with Shield boss (umbo)



9. Bucklers

9.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Bucklers are small round Shields made of wood or metal. They do not have straps but a rigid handle and a Shield boss (umbo).

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors.**

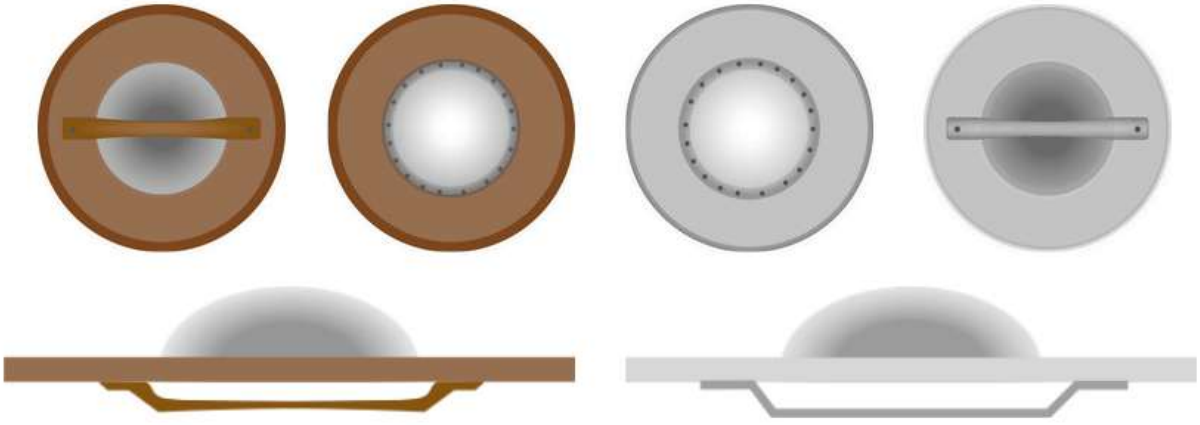


Weltchronik in Versen - 1370 - Germany

9.2. Specific Requirements

Bucklers must:

- conform to the General Requirements and either the Wooden Shield Requirements or the Metal Shield Requirements (see Sections 3, 4 and 5 above),
- be made of wood or metal,
- have a Shield boss (umbo):
  - Shield boss must be made of metal.
  - Shield boss can be riveted or forged.
- have a diameter:
  - **for Buhurt: from 20 cm to 40 cm**,
  - **for Duels: from 20 cm to 35 cm**,
- be flat or curved depending on historical sources.



If the Buckler is made of wood, the handle must be made of wood.

If the Buckler is made of metal, the handle must be made of metal.

A strap can be added to secure the Buckler in punch position. This strap must be made of leather.

9.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Forged shield boss Riveted shield boss Reinforced buckler with cross

Picture from Black Dog Armoury ©



Wooden Buckler

Picture from The Medieval Things ©



Additional leather strap

Picture from Medieval Extreme ©

9.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions



<u>Black painting is not allowed</u> as per "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decoration" document*.

Picture from The Medieval Things ©

10. Fastening Systems

10.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Leather straps were fastened with nails or rivets.

The following methods are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**:

- nails,
- rivets,
- modern nuts and bolts.

Examples:



Nails



Rivet with metal plate

Pictures from Black Dog Armoury ©

10.2. Specific requirements

Nails and rivets can be left visible.

Modern nuts and bolts must be concealed by one of the following methods:

- Covered by a piece of leather nailed to the Shield.
- Painted in black or any other color to make it concealed.
- Hexagonal unpainted bolts must be ground to a rounded shape, replicating a rivet aesthetic.

Bolts must not protrude from the nuts.

10.3. Examples of Approved Systems



Rivets can be visible



Modern nuts and bolts, painted black

Pictures from Medieval Extreme ©

11. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Add:
- “1. Implementation” (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)

Clarification:
- Split of “1. Definition and general requirements” in “2. Definition” and “3. General Requirements”.
- From 1.1. to “4. Wooden Shields requirements” and 1.2. to “5. Metal Shields Requirements”.
- **This doesn’t have an impact on the content of the rules.**

Add: “1. Implementation” (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
- Modification of diameters for Round shields and Bucklers depending on the type of fight.

March-2025 (V2025.02)
- clarification : 6.2
- format: Grammar and Formatting

December-2024: -Add
Document has been created